DIGITAL LITERACY PROJECT

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INTRODUCTION

Project Overview: Digital Literacy

This project focuses on promoting digital literacy, which means educating individuals develop the skills needed to use digital devices, the internet, and online services effectively and safely. The objective was to understand
the digital world by making it easier for people,

especially beginners, to use technology to get information, talk to
others, and do everyday tasks.

Scenario

The project took place in a place where a lot of people didn't know much or anything about digital tools like computers, smartphones, or the internet. Participants were taught basic things like how to use mobile apps, browse the web, send emails, and stay safe online. To make learning useful and relevant, real-life examples were used, such as using government services, paying bills online, and finding educational resources. Emailing professionally, etc.

The outcome of the project was increased confidence among participants in using digital technology, improved access to online resources, and greater awareness of safe and responsible internet use.

TASK 1: Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

For making the infographic, I used Canva as the main design tool because it is easy to use and offers a wide range of templates, graphics, and fonts. It helped me create a neat and visually appealing professional presentation without needing advanced design skills. Also, I used AI features to make the infographic look appealing.

My infographic includes sections on what digital literacy is, explaining its meaning. I also mentioned about the email etiquette which are important to write a perfect professional mail. Moreover, my infographic highlights useful digital tools for students, such as apps and websites that can help with studying and productivity, some of them are Google Docs, Canva, Prezi, Zoom, etc. Lastly, I included safe internet practices to spread awareness about staying secure online and protecting personal information.

While working on this project, one thing I found interesting was exploring different design elements and layouts, templates, fonts, etc. to make the content more engaging. However, I found it a bit difficult to choose the right combination of colours, fonts, sizes and organize all the information clearly without making the design look too crowded.

TASK 2: STUDENT DIGITAL PORTFOLIO

For my project, I chose four important platforms: Kaggle, LinkedIn, GitHub, and ResearchGate, each helps differently in my academic and professional growth.

Kaggle is mainly used for data science and machine learning, where users can access datasets, participate in competitions, and improve their analytical skills. LinkedIn is a professional networking platform that helps individuals connect with experts, showcase their achievements, and explore job opportunities. GitHub is a platform for storing and sharing code, allowing collaboration on projects and helping in building a strong coding portfolio. ResearchGate is designed for researchers and students to share papers, ask questions, and stay updated with academic work.

Over the next four years, I plan to actively use these platforms to build my skills and career. I will use Kaggle to practice data analysis and participate in competitions. On LinkedIn, I will create a professional profile and connect with industry professionals. I will use GitHub to upload my projects and track my progress, while ResearchGate will help me explore research, publish papers and enhance my academic knowledge.

TASK 3: Coding & Collaboration Platforms

Part A - Coding Practice

Part B - Google Workspace Collaboration

For my project, I used the HackerRank platform to practice beginner-level challenge or skill test.

HackerRank is an online platform that helps students improve their programming abilities by solving different types of challenges. In this project, I worked on the “Solve Me First” challenge, which is a basic problem that involves writing a simple program to add two numbers. Although it is an easy task, it helped me understand how to read input, process data, and display output correctly using code.

While completing this challenge, I practiced basic programming concepts such as problem-solving, logical thinking, and writing clean code. It also helped me become familiar with the coding environment.

These tools will help me academically by strengthening my foundation in programming. Regular practice on platforms like HackerRank, Code chef or HackerEarth will improve my confidence and speed in coding, which will be useful for exams, assignments, and future projects. It will also prepare me for more advanced topics and technical interviews in the future.

TASK 4: Draft a Professional Email & Etiquette Guide

Part A – Write two professional emails.

Part B – Create a Social Media Do's and Don'ts checklist

A situation where poor digital communication caused a serious problem could be in a formal email between a student and a teacher. For example, a student needed an extension for an important assignment but sent a poorly written email saying, “Can’t submit. Do something.” The message had no subject line, no proper greeting, and no explanation for the delay. Because of this unclear and rude tone, the teacher misunderstood the situation and assumed the student was not taking the assignment seriously. As a result, the request was ignored, and the student received low marks for late submission.

This issue could have been avoided by using proper email etiquette. The student should have included a clear subject line, such as “Request for Assignment Extension,” and started with a polite greeting. A brief explanation of the reason, along with a respectful tone, would have helped the teacher understand the situation better. Ending the email with a proper closing and name would also make it more professional. Clear and respectful communication is essential to avoid misunderstandings and ensure positive outcomes.

TASK 5: Cybercrime Awareness Case Study & Prevention Guide

Part A – Case Study

Part B – Prevention Checklist

While researching on the topic of cyberbullying, what surprised me the most was how widespread and serious the issue is, even though it often goes unnoticed. I got to know that cyberbullying can happen at any time through social media, emails, or messaging apps, making it difficult for victims to escape. It was shocking to discover that many people do not report such incidents due to fear, embarrassment, or lack of support. I also found it surprising that even seemingly small or “harmless” comments can deeply affect someone’s mental health, leading to stress, anxiety, and loss of self-confidence.

As a result of this research, I will be more responsible and thoughtful in my online behaviour. I will carefully think before posting or commenting to ensure that my words are not hurtful or offensive. Additionally, I will avoid engaging with negative content and will try to support individuals who may be targeted online. By practicing kindness and awareness, I can contribute to creating a safer and more respectful digital environment for everyone.

OVERALL LEARNING

The learning which I gained from the project was that I got to know about the importance of digital literacy. Moreover, got to know about email etiquettes so that I could write it professionally without any significant errors.

Digital literacy is essential for education, employment and daily life. Even after people having smartphones and other digital devices people aren't aware about how to use it.

A major learning was to learn about cyber security involving: recognising scams and phishing, protecting personal information, using strong passwords.

Moreover, learners become more confident in accessing government services, online banking, communication (WhatsApp, email, etc.) It also acts as a gap between rural and urban areas.

REFERENCES

1. UNICEF- Digital learning and literacy resources.
2. GOOGLE DIGITAL GARAGE- Free digital skills training modules.
3. ChatGPT